B2 LESSON 1



Does Everybody Have Access to Technology?

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A As a lead-in question, ask Ss how technology helps them when doing their homework and how much they use the internet to complete assignments. Then ask them to write other uses of technology on a sticky note.

B Ss compare their notes and answer the question. Help with vocabulary if needed. Briefly check answers as a class.

C Read the definition of 'digital divide' aloud and ask Ss to underline the key words (*differences of opportunity – people who can – regularly and easily use – digital technology – people who can't*). You can insist on the importance of access to technology as well as on the importance of being able to use it.

D Briefly encourage Ss to start reflecting on causes of the digital divide before giving them time to make the list of people who may be affected by the digital divide.

SUGGESTED ANSWERS:

A list could include the following:

- people who live in less economically developed countries
- people in low-income households
- people with poor or no digital skills
- old people
- some people with disabilities
- women in some countries
- people who live in remote places

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A Tell Ss they are going to read an article which includes three stories highlighting different aspects of the digital divide. Allow Ss time to read through the article and assist with vocabulary if necessary. Ask them to look again at their lists in Ex 1D and encourage them to add ideas to them.

B Ask Ss to look at the words in bold in the article and match them with definitions 1–4. Ss can check answers in pairs or as a class.

ANSWERS:

1 gender equality
2 empowerment
3 device
4 gamification

C Focus Ss on Question 1. Elicit whether the statement is true or false, or if the information is not given in the article. If they volunteer that the sentence is true or false, ask them to find the place in the text where it says so. They should not be able to find anything if the answer is not given in the text. Explain that they must decide if the rest of the statements are true, false or not given. Allow time for them to work individually and then compare answers with a partner. Get feedback as a class, making sure Ss can justify their answers.

ANSWERS:

1 T 'HeForShe movement which … set up a gamification platform on gender equality and women's empowerment. … there is often the same inequality in the digital world.'
2 NG
3 T 'Every day, she has to get up early and walk 5 km with her children to the nearest place that has an internet connection. That is the only way for her children to attend online classes.'
4 NG
5 F 'Grey digital divide is a major challenge for older people. It can mean that they don't benefit from the digital revolution.'

D Before doing this exercise, ask Ss if they can think of reasons why the digital divide is especially important for some people or in some parts of the world. Give them time to go through the list and help them with vocabulary if needed.

ANSWERS:

1 d
2 b, c, e
3 a, c, d

Note

It may be important to focus Ss' attention on the fact that the digital divide also contributes to inequality of access to goods and services which are available through technology. For example, access to technology improves the quality of education, which can lead to higher wages. Those who live in countries with no or very limited access are therefore disadvantaged. You could introduce the notion of a 'north-south divide', i.e. northern wealthier nations vs southern poorer nations.

Language for citizenship

3 Elicit ideas on how to mitigate or reduce the digital divide for certain categories of people. Ask: *What can be done to reduce the digital divide?* Allow Ss time to complete the matching exercise and help them with vocabulary if requested. Get feedback as a class.

ANSWERS:

1 c **2** e **3** d **4** a **5** b

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CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

4A Give Ss time to read through Article 3 and discuss the question in pairs.

B Pairs compare their ideas. Elicit ideas from the class.

SUGGESTED ANSWER:

The digital divide can limit a citizen's access to certain services, and this contributes to larger inequalities between those who have access to technology and those who haven't. Article 3 mentions the effective participation in the political, economic and social life of the country. Without access to technology, there are services which can't be accessed today.

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Class debate

5A Explain to Ss that they are going to do a class debate and divide them into two groups: one to argue for and the other to argue against digital skills training in primary schools.

B To prepare for the debate, you can ask Ss to create a classroom bulletin board – which could also be organised on a Padlet – with newspaper articles or magazine clippings that show different examples and points of view on the issue.

C Ss debate the question. Encourage each side to listen to the opposing arguments and ask questions.

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